Mathias Fonseca

Senior Staff Engineer, Fintech · Solutions Architect

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15+ Years Experience | 50+ PSP Integrations | $40B GMV Scale | 100+ People Led | 20+ Teams Built

SUMMARY

Senior Staff Engineer in Fintech at Wolt — part of DoorDash's global Money organisation spanning Wolt, Deliveroo, and DoorDash. 15+ years building payment systems at scale across Latin America, Europe, the Middle East, and Asia: founding engineer at Payrails, and earlier scaled Delivery Hero's Global Fintech team from 3 to 100+ people powering $40B annual GMV. Alongside the payments work, I drive how the engineering org adopts AI — raising developer velocity and pushing toward genuinely AI-native engineering. 7 years a Software Architecture professor; conference speaker.

EXPERIENCE

Wolt + DoorDash

Berlin, Germany

Senior Staff Engineer, Fintech — May 2026 – Present

- Technical direction for the international Money platform — payments, payouts, lending, card issuing, and gift cards spanning Wolt, Deliveroo, and DoorDash across Europe, the Middle East, Asia, and the Americas
- Helping bring the three companies' financial solutions onto common ground as they consolidate — the same work I did building Delivery Hero's global fintech and helping merchants consolidate at Payrails
- Driving AI adoption and developer velocity across the org; AI Ambassador moving teams from AI-assisted to genuinely AI-native ways of working, and defining how we evaluate AI-built systems
- Shaping long-term technical direction across teams through architecture docs, prototypes, and RFCs

Payrails

Berlin, Germany

Founding Engineer · Solutions Architect & Principal Engineer — Dec 2021 – Dec 2025

- First employee — designed and built the company's core technical architecture from scratch, now powering enterprise merchants' entire payment stack
- Grew the company to 100+ people across 9 teams (Berlin & Cairo); collaborated across product, tech, GTM, sales, and customer success
- Drove merchant success from zero to first 15 enterprise clients: onboarding, critical issue resolution, and process improvement
- Supported sales pipeline with technical demos, RFPs, and solution design for enterprise prospects
- Maintained the core architecture blueprint and led key technical decisions via RFC-driven processes

Delivery Hero

Berlin, Germany

Global Fintech Principal Engineer — Oct 2020 – Dec 2021

- Helped grow Global Fintech from 3 to 100+ people across 8 specialised teams (Payments, Risk, Compliance, Wallet, Payouts, Integrations, Analytics, Business)
- Provided architectural guidance across 50+ countries powering $40B in annual GMV
- Cross-functional consultant: payments and fraud system design across Delivery Hero's global footprint
- Bridged engineering, product, and compliance to ensure consistency, scalability, and regulatory alignment

Global Payments Senior Engineering Manager — May 2019 – Oct 2020

- Built the Global Fintech team from scratch at Delivery Hero HQ
- Designed scalable payment solutions across diverse market requirements; expanded to new payment methods
- Led cross-functional teams on fraud prevention, compliance, and checkout optimisation

PedidosYa

Montevideo, Uruguay

Shopping Tribe Technical Leader — Jan 2019 – Apr 2019

- Led 5 teams (~30 engineers) across Ordering, Checkout, Payments, and Fraud for Latin America's #1 food delivery platform — 15 countries, $2.5B+ GMV
- Ensured architectural consistency across platforms and markets; aligned with Product and stakeholders

Payments & Fraud Prevention Engineering Manager — Sep 2016 – Apr 2019

- Led the Payments and Fraud Prevention Squad — set OKRs, planned projects, negotiated with PSPs, balanced stakeholder interests
- Continued as full-stack engineer and API designer across payment integration and fraud prevention systems

Senior Full Stack Engineer Oct 2013 – Sep 2016

- One of the first engineers — built the platform from scratch, expanding across 12+ countries
- Developed deep expertise in payment systems and fraud prevention in one of the world's highest-fraud markets

Universidad ORT Uruguay

Montevideo, Uruguay

Software Architecture Professor Aug 2012 – Apr 2019

- 7 years teaching Software Architecture for BSc Software Engineering and Computer Science; Architectural Patterns, Quality Attributes, Tactics with Java EE

Software Engineering in the Cloud Professor Jul 2014 – Sep 2015

- Advanced course on cloud architecture, Web APIs, and deployment strategies

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Softruck — CTO	Belo Horizonte, Brazil	Sep–Dec 2015
MercadoLibre — Software Engineer	Montevideo, Uruguay	May–Oct 2013
Tata Consultancy Services — Business Analyst & .NET Developer	Montevideo, Uruguay	2010–2013
TECHO — IT Manager / Volunteer (anti-poverty NGO)	Montevideo, Uruguay	2008–2011

SKILLS & DOMAIN EXPERTISE

Languages	Java · Kotlin · Go · Groovy · Python · TypeScript · React
Infrastructure	AWS · Docker · Kubernetes · Terraform
Data	PostgreSQL · Redis · Kafka · BigQuery
Payments Domain	50+ PSP integrations · Orchestration · Fraud prevention · Chargebacks · Payouts
Compliance	PCI-DSS · GDPR · SCA / PSD2 / Open Banking · AML/KYC · ISO 27001
Architecture	Domain-Driven Design · Event-driven architecture · RFC-driven decisions · Distributed systems
AI & Dev Productivity	AI-native engineering · Developer velocity · Applied LLMs · Agentic workflows · AI adoption
Leadership	Cross-functional team leadership · OKRs · Technical strategy · Mentorship · Solutions architecture
Human Languages	Spanish (Native) · English (Fluent) · Portuguese (Professional) · German (B1) · Italian (Elementary)

EDUCATION

Big Data & Machine Learning Specialization	Universidad ORT Uruguay · 2018–2020
BSc in Information Technology	Universidad ORT Uruguay · 2008–2012

SELECTED TALKS & PUBLICATIONS

[Conference Talk] Payments Engineering and Stoicism	QuantumTech 2021
[Conference Panel] Payments in the Sharing Economy	PAYMENTSfn 2019
[Article] Mastering PSP Integrations	mathifonseca.me
[Article] A Survival Guide for Payments	mathifonseca.me
[Case Study] PedidosYa Payment Infrastructure	Spreedly
[Podcast] Payments and Delivery in Latin America	LATAM payments series